

Adverbs

AN ADVERB MODIFIES A VERB, AN ADJECTIVE, OR ANOTHER ADVERB.

The word *adverb* essentially means “to add to a verb,” and this is what adverbs mostly do. They provide information about how, when, where, or how often something is happening, and to what degree.

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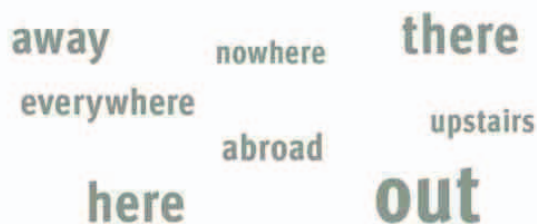
When and how often?

Adverbs of time indicate when something is happening, while adverbs of frequency indicate how often it is happening. These adverbs modify verbs, and can occupy different positions in a sentence—usually at the beginning or end of a clause.



Where?

Adverbs of place work in the same way as adverbs of time and frequency. They modify verbs and tell the reader more about where something is happening.



Yesterday we went out. We left an extremely large dog saw us.

Forming common adverbs

Most adverbs in English are formed by adding the ending *-ly* to an adjective, but there are some exceptions. Some adjectives, such as *lovely* or *holy*, also end in *-ly*, so it's important not to confuse these with adverbs.

Adjective ending	Rule	Adverb
-l (beautiful, wonderful)	Add <i>-ly</i>	beautifully, wonderfully
-y (pretty, busy, hungry)	Change <i>-y</i> to <i>-i</i> , then add <i>-ly</i>	prettily, busily, hungrily
-le (comfortable, reputable)	Change <i>-e</i> to <i>-y</i>	comfortably, reputably
-ic (enthusiastic, ecstatic)	Add <i>-ally</i>	enthusiastically, ecstatically
-ly (friendly, daily)	Use an adverbial phrase	in a friendly way, every day